

ENGLISH, POWER, ACCESS

Before English

BRITAIN, LANGUAGES, POWER

02 / 12



Britain spoke earlier languages

BRITTONIC

Local speech

Many regional varieties.

LATIN

Roman power

Public writing expanded.

ENGLISH

Not established

Settlement came later.

Speaker totals remain unknown.

Rome arrived in 43

43 CE

ROMAN RULE

EARLY 400s



Invasion began

Armies carried Latin.



Officials used Latin

Stones displayed Latin.



**Rule from Rome
ended**

Languages still changed.

Latin survives on objects

VINDOLANDA TABLET 234

97–105 CE

A private Latin letter.

Military life became visible.

VERBEIA ALTAR

DATE UNKNOWN

Latin names local worship.

A river goddess remains.

Objects show written choices.

Brittonic survives indirectly

EVIDENCE

Local names survived.

Deities kept local names.

Places kept older roots.

INFERENCE

Brittonic speech continued.

Bilingual lives were likely.

Latin never tells everything.

Exact speech patterns remain unproven.

Records follow power

01

ARMY

Latin tablets survive.

**Power produced
records.**

02

PUBLIC WORSHIP

Latin marked altars.

**Local names
remained.**

03

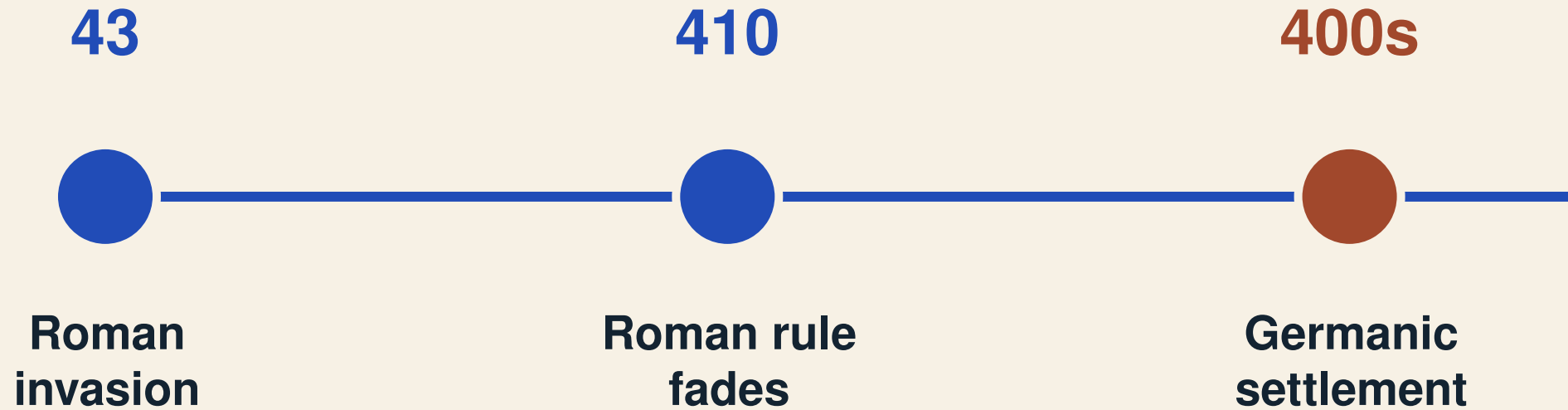
HOMES

Few records survive.

**Speech stays
uncertain.**

Records ≠ all speech.

English came later



Old English formed afterward.

No single switch occurred.

Sources and limits

English Heritage

Roman Britain timeline

Roman Inscriptions

Tablets and altars

LatinNow research

Multilingual Roman West

Texas Linguistics

Old English timeline

Writing survives unevenly.

Speaker totals remain unknown.

NEXT: Vikings and Normans